

sale on chicken breast? Go nuts with two or three bulk recipes that you can grab out of the freezer for dinner on the fly later on.

Flash freezing

This is particularly important for individual items you want to serve in a batch, but don't want sticking together in the freezer container. You'll need to set aside a free shelf at least temporarily. Space out the items on a cookie sheet and freeze rock-solid. Then transfer in family- or appetizer-size amounts to the appropriate storage item. A few ideas where this comes in handy include homemade chicken drumsticks, breaded veal portions, mozzarella sticks, and frozen breaded eggplant slices.

Start small and simplify

Breaking down large cans of cheese sauce and jalapeños into small containers of simple nacho dip, and doing bagged, flat-frozen, large-batch leftovers can go further than you think. One giant batch of spaghetti sauce can easily result in at least a dozen gallon-sized flat-frozen freezer bags. That translates to three months' worth of having one night off from dinner per week. If you take even one of those nights to whip up a few large batches of dry mixes, you'll really be on a roll.

— **Myscha Theriault**

4 Small Kitchen Gadgets That Equal Big Savings!



Here are four nifty appliances for the kitchen that can keep things cheap and simple at your home. Plus, learn how to get some of them for way below retail value.

1. The bread machine

I have always enjoyed making my own bread. Eventually, however, I really grew tired of kneading dough, waiting around for it to rise, and then using plenty of good oven juice to bake it. To get the same delicious results as a conventional oven, try a mid-range bread machine. For the absolute best savings: